

A 20-YEAR CREATOR JOURNEY

ARUN PRABHUDESAI'S WORK MANTRA

When he began blogging in 2007, Arun wasn't driven by ambition, but curiosity. Living in the US and preparing to return to India, he noticed a lack of India-focused tech content and decided to document it himself. What started as a simple, personal project soon gained momentum, which eventually gave him the confidence to leave a stable job and return home. That early instinct to simplify and share became the foundation of a two-decade journey built on consistency and trust.

Challenges and opportunities of a content creator in India?

India is a tough market for creators. There's no doubt about that. But at the same time, it's one of the most exciting places to build something.

On the challenging side, monetisation is still relatively low compared to global markets. Competition is intense, and the audience is very sharp. The moment they feel a drop in authenticity, they move on.

In my own journey, the hardest phase was the beginning, when nothing seemed to work. Very low views, almost no growth, and constant self-doubt. That phase tests you. A lot of people give up in that early phase because it feels like nothing is happening. But that's actually where the real opportunity lies.

Tell us about your journey from being a solo creator to an entrepreneur

and angel investor?

When I started as a solo creator, one thing became clear very quickly, I couldn't do everything myself. If I wanted to grow and create quality content consistently, I needed people who were better than me in specific areas. Looking back, that has been one of the biggest reasons for whatever we've been able to build. A strong team changes everything.

The real shift from creator to entrepreneur happened when I realised that content can scale, but an individual cannot. That's when we started building processes, structuring workflows, and eventually expanding into multiple channels. That's when it truly started feeling like a business.

Investing came much later, and it felt like a natural progression. When you spend years understanding audiences, distribution, and attention, you start recognising patterns. You begin to see what works, what doesn't, and where real value can be created. It takes time, patience, and consistency to build something meaningful.

Advice for creators on chasing revenue vs creating a unique voice?
There's always a strong temptation

to optimize for revenue, especially in the early days. You start getting brand offers, and it's easy to say yes to everything. But if you go down that path too early, you slowly dilute your voice. And once the audience starts questioning your intent, it's very difficult to rebuild that trust.

In my case, the first couple of years were focused purely on building credibility. Financially, it wasn't easy. There were opportunities we could have taken, but we chose not to because they didn't feel right.

Even today, we are very selective. We probably say no to more than 70% of the campaigns that come our way. Because for us, trust and honesty are non-negotiable. That's the foundation of everything we've built so far.

I've always believed that revenue is a byproduct. Trust comes first. Revenue follows. **d**